Bae Okile Mangondato Sharief

Bae Okile Mangondato Sharief, PhD (Alhadja), is a Filipino educator, philanthropist, and community leader who founded **Lanao Central College, Inc. (LCCI)** in Marawi City—famously known as "The Home of Free Tuition Fee." A member of the Maranao ethnic group, she holds the traditional title of **Bae** (noblewoman) and has dedicated her life to providing accessible education in post-conflict Mindanao. Her humanitarian work earned her the Mother Teresa Award and appointment as a World Peace Ambassador, making her one of the most influential Bangsamoro women in contemporary Philippines.

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Early Life and Family

Dr. Sharief was born into one of Lanao del Sur's most prominent families of educators and traditional leaders. She is the youngest daughter of **Hadji Ali Alimatar Sawasa Sharief** and **Dr. Norma Mangondato Sharief**, the latter widely recognized as the "Mother of Education" in Lanao del Sur. Her family lineage traces back to the **First Sultan of Cabugatan sa Poona Masiu**, connecting her to centuries of Maranao royal heritage.

Her late brother, **Agakhan "Bin Laden" Sharief**, became a local hero during the 2017 Marawi Siege when he brokered critical ceasefires to rescue trapped civilians. His death deeply influenced Dr. Sharief's commitment to peace-building and humanitarian service in the region.

Ethnic Affiliation and Cultural Significance

As a member of the **Maranao people**, Dr. Sharief represents one of the Philippines' major Muslim indigenous groups. The Maranao, also spelled Meranaw, are primarily based around Lake Lanao in Mindanao and maintain distinct cultural practices, including a matrilineal nobility system.

The title **Bae** designates her status as a traditional noblewoman in Maranao society, carrying both cultural authority and social responsibility. This position allows her to bridge traditional leadership structures with modern institutional frameworks, particularly in advocating for women's empowerment in Muslim-majority regions. Her work is deeply rooted in **Bangsamoro** cultural and religious values, making her a role model for young Maranao women pursuing education and public service.

Education

Dr. Sharief holds multiple advanced degrees that reflect her commitment to lifelong learning:

- **Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)**
- **Doctor of Education (Ed.D.)**
- **Doctor of Humane Letters (D.Hum.)** – Honorary degree conferred by Ganka International Awards (Gawad Agila ng Kadakilaan) in 2024 in recognition of her humanitarian excellence

Her academic credentials complement her traditional cultural authority, positioning her as both a modern educator and a respected traditional leader.

Career and Institutional Leadership

Lanao Central College, Inc. (LCCI)

In 2012, Dr. Sharief founded **Lanao Central College, Inc. (LCCI)** in Marawi City, establishing what would become known as "The Home of Free Tuition Fee." The institution revolutionized higher education accessibility in conflict-affected Lanao del Sur by offering completely free first-year tuition across multiple degree programs.

LCCI provides undergraduate programs in Criminology, Civil Engineering, Computer Science, Social Work, Agriculture, Elementary Education, and Islamic Studies (Major in Shari'ah), along with graduate programs including Master in Public Administration and Master of Arts in Education. The college specifically targets marginalized students, offering specialized support for orphans (*Wata a Ilo*), children of mujahideen, persons with disabilities (PWDs), and the economically disadvantaged (*miskeen*).

The institution's impact is measurable: in 2026 alone, LCCI produced 58 new Criminology board passers, demonstrating the quality of education alongside its accessibility.

Bae Okile Mangondato Sharief



Photo needed

Alhadja, PhD, Ed.D., D.Hum.	
Born	Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao (Meranaw)
Occupation	Educator, Philanthropist, Community Leader
Known for	Founder of Lanao Central College (LCCI) Free Tuition Education Model Post-Marawi Siege Humanitarian Work
Title	Bae (Noblewoman) Alhadja (Hajj Pilgrim)
Education	Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) Doctor of Education (Ed.D.) Doctor of Humane Letters (D.Hum., honorary)
Parent(s)	Hadji Ali Alimatar Sawasa Sharief (father) Dr. Norma Mangondato Sharief (mother)
Awards	Mother Teresa Award World Peace Prize (2024) Outstanding Philanthropist of the Year Honorary Public Servant of the Year (2023, 2024, 2025)

PMTC Laboratory School Inc.

Dr. Sharief also serves as President of **PMTC Laboratory School Inc.**, extending her educational mission to primary and secondary education levels.

Humanitarian Work and Peace-Building

Post-Marawi Siege Response

Following the devastating 2017 Marawi Siege, Dr. Sharief mobilized LCCI and personal resources to provide critical humanitarian assistance. She organized medical aid, distributed relief goods, and offered community legal services to internally displaced persons (IDPs). Her efforts helped stabilize education in the region when many institutions had been destroyed.

Continuing her late brother's legacy of mediation and peace advocacy, she supported government peace initiatives and created educational opportunities as a form of community healing. Her work embodies the principle that education is essential infrastructure for post-conflict recovery.

Community Outreach Programs

Beyond classroom education, Dr. Sharief regularly hosts massive community events distributing *ayuda* (aid) such as grocery packs and water to hundreds of participants. These initiatives reinforce community resilience and demonstrate her commitment to holistic social welfare.

Awards and Recognition

Dr. Sharief has received extensive international and national recognition for her dual contributions to education and humanitarian service.

International Awards

- **World Peace Prize (2024)** – Conferred alongside ambassadors from various countries for dedicated humanitarian efforts
- **World Peace Ambassador** – Appointed by the World Peace Committee (WPC) for pursuit of regional stability and social healing
- **Mother Teresa Award** – Distinctive worldwide recognition for lifetime philanthropic work
- **Asian Sterling Awards (2022)** – "Most Outstanding Individual Achievement as Humanitarian Ambassador"
- **Global Educator's Award** – Recognized for innovative approach to accessible higher education

National Awards

- **Honorary Public Servant of the Year (2025)** – Excellence in Foreign Relations and Foreign Affairs (Nation Builders & Mosliv Awards)
- **Honorary Public Servant of the Year (2024)** – Excellence in Foreign Relations and Diplomatic Affairs, ceremony at Okada Manila
- **Honorary Public Servant of the Year (2023)** – Excellence in Peace and Nation Building, contributions toward UN Sustainable Development Goals

- **Philippines Choice Awards (2024)** – National Outstanding Humanitarian and Community Service
- **Outstanding Philanthropist of the Year** – Gawad Filipino Awards as social-civic icon
- **Noble Woman of Influence & Empowered Business Leader of the Year**

Personal Values and Philosophy

Dr. Sharief's life work is guided by the philosophy of "selfless contribution" to the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), particularly focusing on quality education (SDG 4), poverty reduction (SDG 1), and peace (SDG 16). Her frequent use of *Alhamdulillah* (praise be to God) reflects her deep Islamic faith, which informs her humanitarian approach.

As an **Alhadja** (one who has completed the Hajj pilgrimage), she integrates Islamic principles of charity (*zakat*) and community service (*sadaqah*) into her institutional mission. She participates regularly in *Umrah* (lesser pilgrimage) and views education as a form of worship and service to humanity.

Legacy and Impact

Dr. Sharief's significance lies in her ability to merge traditional Maranao leadership with modern educational administration. By leveraging her cultural authority as a Bae and her international diplomatic standing as a World Peace Ambassador, she created a scalable blueprint for educational philanthropy in post-conflict zones.

The LCCI "Free Tuition" model demonstrates that accessible higher education can function sustainably while maintaining academic quality. Her work challenges conventional assumptions about the relationship between educational quality and cost, proving that institutions can prioritize social mission without compromising standards.

Her leadership provides a template for women in Muslim-majority regions of Southeast Asia, showing how traditional cultural roles can be vehicles for progressive social change rather than barriers to it. By maintaining her titles as Bae and Alhadja while simultaneously holding doctoral degrees and international awards, she embodies a synthesis of tradition and modernity.

Cultural and Regional Significance

As one of the most visible Bangsamoro women leaders in contemporary Philippines, Dr. Sharief plays a crucial role in representing Maranao perspectives in national discourse. Her work in Marawi City—a symbolic center of Islamic culture in the Philippines—carries particular weight in the context of ongoing peace processes between the Philippine government and Moro groups.

Her institutional presence in Marawi also serves as a counter-narrative to extremism, demonstrating that Islamic values and modern education are complementary rather than contradictory. The survival and growth of LCCI despite the 2017 siege symbolizes the resilience of Maranao civil society.

See also

- Maranao people
- Lanao del Sur
- Battle of Marawi
- Bangsamoro

- Education in the Philippines
- Islamic education

External links

- Lanao Central College Official Facebook Page (https://www.facebook.com/OfficialLCCI/)

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